

TENTATIVE RULING

Case: **Lai v. ZK Sacramento Properties, LLC et al.**
Case No. CV2025-1043

Hearing Date: **September 1, 2026** **Department Thirteen** **9:00 a.m.**

On its own motion, the Court **STRIKES** Kwong Lai aka Bosco Lai's opposition (filed June 22, 2026) and the declaration of Kwong Lai (filed June 22, 2026) because Kwong Lai is not an attorney and therefore, may not participate in this action on behalf of Raising Green Properties, Inc. (See Code Civ. Proc., § 128, subd. (a)(8); Bus. & Prof. Code, § 6125; Corp. Code, § 2010; *CLD Construction, Inc. v. City of San Ramon* (2004) 120 Cal.App.4th 1141, 1145 ["...a corporation, unlike a natural person, cannot represent itself before courts of record in propria persona, nor can it represent itself through a corporate officer, director or other employee who is not an attorney"]; *Vann v. Shilleh* (1975) 54 Cal.App.3d 192, 199.)

Defendants ZK Sacramento Properties, LLC, Travis Monson, and The Vollman Company, Inc.'s motion for sanctions is **DENIED**. (Code Civ. Proc., § 128.7.) First, although defendants sent plaintiff this motion before filing it, defendants did not include a notice of motion reflecting when the motion would be heard. (*J.N. v. Goldberg* (2026) 120 Cal.App.5th 544, 549-550 ["a notice of motion seeking section 128.7 sanctions must reflect when the motion will be heard"]; Code Civ. Proc., §§ 128.7, subd. (c)(1), 1010; Lopez decl., ¶ 17, Exhibits J & K.) Second, defendants' motion does not track statute and therefore, the Court finds that defendants have failed to demonstrate how plaintiff violated section 128.7 such that sanctions are warranted. (See Code Civ. Proc., § 128.7, subds. (b), (d), & (e).) Finally, in the reply, defendants also request sanctions against attorney Tianwen Xu. (See Reply, p. 8.) But such a request is improper because it was made for the first time in the reply. (See *Prince v. United National Ins. Co.* (2006) 142 Cal.App.4th 233, 238.)

If no hearing is requested, this tentative ruling is effective immediately. No formal order pursuant to California Rules of Court, rule 3.1312 or further notice is required.

TENTATIVE RULING

Case: **Lemonade Insurance Company v. Hartmeyer**
 Case No. CV2025-2934

Hearing Date: **September 1, 2026** **Department Fourteen** **9:00 a.m.**

Plaintiff Lemonade Insurance Company's motion to deem request for admissions admitted, and for sanctions in the amount of \$585.00 is **DENIED WITHOUT PREJUDICE**. (Code Civ. Proc., §§ 2023.010, 2033.280.) Plaintiff failed to serve the moving papers on defendant Sarah Catherine Hartmeyer's counsel by electronic service as required. (Cal. Rules of Court, rule 2.251(c); Code Civ. Proc., § 1010.6, subd. (i); YCR 7.2.)

The notice of motion provides notice of this Court's tentative ruling system. However, the notice does not contain the required language pursuant to Local Rule 11.2(b) (as amended, eff. Jan. 1, 2023). Counsel for moving party, or the moving party if unrepresented by counsel, is ordered to notify the opposing party or parties immediately of the tentative ruling system.

If no hearing is requested, and no party appears at the hearing, this tentative ruling is effective immediately. No formal order pursuant to California Rules of Court, rule 3.1312 or further notice is required.